

Final Fantasy Report: Learned Archetypes, Bombs, and Synergies

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Dataset Snapshot

This run uses 173,242 unique deck builds and 769,659 game rows. The unsupervised clustering stage produced 11 learned archetypes. The best-performing large shells are Izzet | Sahagin / Blazing Bomb, Boros Humans | Weapons Vendor / Paladin's Arms, Golgari Humans | Shinra Reinforcements / Town Greeter, which already tells us that the format is not a single monolithic color table: it separates into distinct deck families with their own signposts, core cards, and build-around incentives.

1 Discovered Archetypes

Archetype	Decks	Games	WR	Top signposts
Izzet Sahagin / Blazing Bomb	23,536	109,292	57.14%	Sahagin, Blazing Bomb, Shantotto, Tactician Magician, Call the Mountain Chocobo, The Emperor of Palamecia
Boros Humans Weapons Vendor / Paladin's Arms	15,088	67,889	56.92%	Weapons Vendor, Paladin's Arms, White Mage's Staff, Zidane, Tantalus Thief, Slash of Light
Golgari Humans Shinra Reinforcements / Town Greeter	21,300	96,603	56.53%	Shinra Reinforcements, Town Greeter, Cloud of Darkness, Fight On!, Exdeath, Void Warlock
Orzhov Humans Rufus Shinra / Judge Magister Gabranth	15,263	68,185	56.19%	Rufus Shinra, Judge Magister Gabranth, White Mage's Staff, White Auracite, Dwarven Castle Guard
Azorius Gaelicat / White Auracite	16,722	74,183	55.88%	Gaelicat, White Auracite, White Mage's Staff, Cid, Timeless Artificer, Paladin's Arms
Dimir Humans Locke Cole / Cornered by Black Mages	15,671	70,726	55.76%	Locke Cole, Cornered by Black Mages, Hecteyes, Ultimecia, Time Sorceress, Vayne's Treachery

Archetype	Decks	Games	WR	Top signposts
Selesnya Humans Rinoa Heartilly / Garnet, Princess of Alexandria	11,140	48,611	55.64%	Rinoa Heartilly, Garnet, Princess of Alexandria, Summon: Choco/Mog, Summon: Fat Chocobo, White Auracite
Simic Humans Ignis Scientia / Omega, Heartless Evolution	19,770	85,474	54.99%	Ignis Scientia, Omega, Heartless Evolution, Town Greeter, Travel the Overworld, Qiqirn Merchant
Rakdos Humans Mysidian Elder / Garland, Knight of Cornelia	13,842	60,241	54.52%	Mysidian Elder, Garland, Knight of Cornelia, Black Mage's Rod, Cornered by Black Mages, Black Waltz No. 3
Blue Base Scorpion Sentinel / Retrieve the Esper	8,915	37,469	53.43%	Scorpion Sentinel, Retrieve the Esper, Sahagin, Dragoon's Wyvern, Ice Magic
Gruul Humans Gladiolus Amicitia / Gysahl Greens	11,995	50,986	53.20%	Gladiolus Amicitia, Gysahl Greens, Summon: Fat Chocobo, Chocobo Kick, Prishe's Wanderings

2 What Defines the Best Shells

Izzet | Sahagin / Blazing Bomb

This cluster contains 23,536 decks across 109,292 games and posts a baseline win rate of 57.14%. Its defining cards are Sahagin, Blazing Bomb, Shantotto, Tactician Magician, Call the Mountain Chocobo, The Emperor of Palamecia, Retrieve the Esper.

The strongest positive links in the shell are . The build-around detector flags no high-confidence build-arounds as true support-dependent payoffs, while the shell-dependence score describes the broader class of cards that rely heavily on the surrounding shell.

Boros Humans | Weapons Vendor / Paladin's Arms

This cluster contains 15,088 decks across 67,889 games and posts a baseline win rate of 56.92%. Its defining cards are Weapons Vendor, Paladin's Arms, White Mage's Staff, Zidane, Tantalus Thief, Slash of Light, Item Shopkeep.

The strongest positive links in the shell are . The build-around detector flags no high-confidence build-arounds as true support-dependent payoffs, while the shell-dependence score describes the broader class of cards that rely heavily on the surrounding shell.

Golgari Humans | Shinra Reinforcements / Town Greeter

This cluster contains 21,300 decks across 96,603 games and posts a baseline win rate of 56.53%. Its defining cards are Shinra Reinforcements, Town Greeter, Cloud of Darkness, Fight On!,

Exdeath, Void Warlock, Resentful Revelation.

The strongest positive links in the shell are . The build-around detector flags no high-confidence build-arounds as true support-dependent payoffs, while the shell-dependence score describes the broader class of cards that rely heavily on the surrounding shell.

Orzhov Humans | Rufus Shinra / Judge Magister Gabranth

This cluster contains 15,263 decks across 68,185 games and posts a baseline win rate of 56.19%. Its defining cards are Rufus Shinra, Judge Magister Gabranth, White Mage's Staff, White Auracite, Dwarven Castle Guard, Black Mage's Rod.

The strongest positive links in the shell are . The build-around detector flags no high-confidence build-arounds as true support-dependent payoffs, while the shell-dependence score describes the broader class of cards that rely heavily on the surrounding shell.

3 Bombs: Cards That Are Good Alone

Card	Best cluster	Standalone lift	Drawn-game WR	Games
Nibelheim Aflame	Gruul Humans Gladiolus Amicitia / Gysahl Greens	13.59 pp	66.79%	557
Ardyn, the Usurper	Dimir Humans Locke Cole / Cornered by Black Mages	13.52 pp	69.28%	2575
Cryptic Command	Simic Humans Ignis Scientia / Omega, Heartless Evolution	13.06 pp	68.05%	241
Dion, Bahamut's Dominant	Selesnya Humans Rinoa Heartilly / Garnet, Princess of Alexandria	12.94 pp	68.58%	1184
Seifer Almasy	Gruul Humans Gladiolus Amicitia / Gysahl Greens	12.12 pp	65.32%	940
Summon: Primal Odin	Golgari Humans Shinra Reinforcements / Town Greeter	11.24 pp	67.77%	2349
Jill, Shiva's Dominant	Rakdos Humans Mysidian Elder / Garland, Knight of Cornelia	10.52 pp	65.03%	143
Smuggler's Copter	Azorius Gaelicat / White Auracite	10.40 pp	66.28%	172
Esper Origins	Simic Humans Ignis Scientia / Omega, Heartless Evolution	10.25 pp	65.24%	2779

Card	Best cluster	Standalone lift	Drawn-game WR	Games
Kuja, Genome Sorcerer	Rakdos Humans Mysidian Elder / Garland, Knight of Cornelia	9.96 pp	64.48%	3651
Choco-Comet	Izzet Sahagin / Blazing Bomb	9.35 pp	66.49%	11237
Vial Smasher the Fierce	Izzet Sahagin / Blazing Bomb	8.99 pp	66.13%	124

4 Build-Arounds and Shell Dependence

Card	Best cluster	Shell dependence	Support delta	Supported games
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5 Dependency Cards

Card	Best cluster	Dependency	Standalone lift	Games
Undercity Dire Rat	Dimir Humans Locke Cole / Cornered by Black Mages	0.407	1.45 pp	10071
Ardyn, the Usurper	Dimir Humans Locke Cole / Cornered by Black Mages	0.407	13.52 pp	2575
Sahagin	Izzet Sahagin / Blazing Bomb	0.000	2.53 pp	30920
Ice Magic	Izzet Sahagin / Blazing Bomb	0.000	5.98 pp	25363
Thunder Magic	Izzet Sahagin / Blazing Bomb	0.000	5.30 pp	23965
Dreams of Laguna	Izzet Sahagin / Blazing Bomb	0.000	3.90 pp	23685
Call the Mountain Chocobo	Izzet Sahagin / Blazing Bomb	0.000	4.14 pp	23609
Retrieve the Esper	Izzet Sahagin / Blazing Bomb	0.000	2.96 pp	22881
Dragoon's Wyvern	Izzet Sahagin / Blazing Bomb	0.000	3.41 pp	22161
Blazing Bomb	Izzet Sahagin / Blazing Bomb	0.000	1.84 pp	22134

Card	Best cluster	Dependency	Standalone lift	Games
Combat Tutorial	Izzet Sahagin / Blazing Bomb	0.000	4.27 pp	20035
Syncopate	Izzet Sahagin / Blazing Bomb	0.000	2.91 pp	19138

6 Best Draft Priorities

Card	Best cluster	Pick score	Draft win lift	Rarity
Cloud of Darkness	Golgari Humans Shinra Reinforcements / Town Greeter	10.0 / 10	1.80 pp	uncommon
Omega, Heartless Evolution	Simic Humans Ignis Scientia / Omega, Heartless Evolution	10.0 / 10	1.13 pp	uncommon
Choco-Comet	Izzet Sahagin / Blazing Bomb	10.0 / 10	2.17 pp	uncommon
Kuja, Genome Sorcerer	Rakdos Humans Mysidian Elder / Garland, Knight of Cornelia	10.0 / 10	2.81 pp	rare
Ardyn, the Usurper	Golgari Humans Shinra Reinforcements / Town Greeter	10.0 / 10	3.58 pp	rare
Ice Magic	Izzet Sahagin / Blazing Bomb	10.0 / 10	1.01 pp	common
White Auracite	Azorius Gaelicat / White Auracite	10.0 / 10	1.30 pp	common
Thunder Magic	Izzet Sahagin / Blazing Bomb	9.8 / 10	1.11 pp	common
Ignis Scientia	Simic Humans Ignis Scientia / Omega, Heartless Evolution	10.0 / 10	1.01 pp	uncommon
Esper Origins	Simic Humans Ignis Scientia / Omega, Heartless Evolution	10.0 / 10	4.40 pp	rare
Samurai's Katana	Boros Humans Weapons Vendor / Paladin's Arms	10.0 / 10	2.70 pp	uncommon
Gladiolus Amicitia	Gruul Humans Gladiolus Amicitia / Gysahl Greens	10.0 / 10	0.65 pp	uncommon

7 Most Striking Positive Pairs

Pair	Cluster	Quality	Pair WR	Games
Ardyn, the Usurper, Undercity Dire Rat	Dimir Humans Locke Cole / Cornered by Black Mages	2.61	78.23%	395

8 Anti-Synergies Worth Respecting

Pair	Cluster	Anti-score	Pair WR	Games
Aerith Rescue Mission, Fate of the Sun-Cryst	Selesnya Humans Ri- noa Heartilly / Garnet, Princess of Alexandria	0.68	47.69%	411
Goobbue Gardener, Gysahl Greens	Selesnya Humans Ri- noa Heartilly / Garnet, Princess of Alexandria	0.67	45.36%	474
Quina, Qu Gourmet, White Mage's Staff	Selesnya Humans Ri- noa Heartilly / Garnet, Princess of Alexandria	0.54	46.13%	297
Blitzball Shot, The Crystal's Chosen	Selesnya Humans Ri- noa Heartilly / Garnet, Princess of Alexandria	0.50	48.98%	147
Ambrosia Whiteheart, Slash of Light	Selesnya Humans Ri- noa Heartilly / Garnet, Princess of Alexandria	0.40	49.88%	407
Gigantoad, Sidequest: Raise a Chocobo	Gruul Humans Gladi- olus Amicitia / Gysahl Greens	0.38	46.21%	396
Balamb T-Rexaur, Blitzball Shot	Gruul Humans Gladi- olus Amicitia / Gysahl Greens	0.36	49.46%	556
Choco-Comet, Sazh's Chocobo	Gruul Humans Gladi- olus Amicitia / Gysahl Greens	0.34	49.55%	222
Blitzball Shot, Gysahl Greens	Selesnya Humans Ri- noa Heartilly / Garnet, Princess of Alexandria	0.33	49.32%	292
Dragoon's Lance, Quina, Qu Gourmet	Selesnya Humans Ri- noa Heartilly / Garnet, Princess of Alexandria	0.33	48.75%	160

9 Bottom-Line Reading

This report treats the format as a deck ecosystem rather than a flat card ranking. The strongest cards show up in the bomb table because they win on their own. The cards that pull a cluster together show up in the build-around and dependency tables because they need a shell. The pair and anti-synergy sections then explain which combinations reinforce a winning plan and which combinations look attractive in draft but underperform together.